Project Name
Vanessa Villa
Plot Area
29,267.07 sq ft
(¼ is built and ¾ is green landscape)
Location
Alua Near Gandhinagar, Ahmedabad
Design Firm
tHE gRID Architects
Designers
Snehal Suthar and
Bhadri Suthar



IN THE LAP OF NATURE
A traditional swing complements the earthy-toned seating in this outdoor sit out by the pond (left); the exterior of the home (below)

Photographs by: PHOTOGRAPHIX INDIA



The stress of urban living is well known. Hectic schedules, uncomfortable commutes, lack of access to nature. This villa was designed as an antidote to the cumulative effect of such pressures. The home is crafted as a calming space that welcomes sunlight and greenery with open arms and adds their beneficial presence to soothing juxtapositions of pastels and timber following the philosophy of biophilia.

Outside Inside

The home's architecture effortlessly fuses light, air, greenery, materials, and scenic vistas, employing a vocabulary that exudes serenity and harmony in a holistic manner. This intuitive interaction with the forces of nature creates a dynamism that lends itself to the indoor-outdoor dialogue that is at the heart of the architecture.

Very Vocal for Local

The building, in turn, engages directly with its location, gradually incorporating materials from the surrounding region, drawing inspiration from the native stone's distinctive colours and textures. Devoid of artificial facade embellishments, the structure's geometry prioritises function over form, accentuating a balanced coexistence. In adherence to climate-responsive architectural principles, recessed windows and pockets of terraces are strategically integrated to mitigate the relentless heat of the area.

Plot and Plan

The layout evolved organically, tailored to the family's unique requirements, resulting in a home that exudes a comforting and hospitable ambiance. As you cross the threshold, you're embraced by the twin spaces, with the indoor swimming pool and the living room flanking the entrance separated by a double height staircase that leads to the more private areas.

Drawing a Distinction

The living room extends to a kitchen on one end while at the other; it opens up to the expansive garden. This sprawling outdoor space features a cascading rockfall waterfall filled with fish and native plants with a spacious deck adorned with inviting, comfortable seating, including the traditional Indian swing, known as jhula.